Growing Businesses Online: Local Tire Retailer

For multi-location tire dealer in a small geography, a new strategy was needed to get the rubber back on the road.

adtaxi

Campaign Goal:

Client had several objectives:

1. Serve location-specific phone numbers.
2. Minimize internal competition in ad service (between locations).
3. Successfully track and optimize to calls.
4. Optimize toward store location.
5. Generate enough quality volume to scale growth.

Challenge:

Grow their online presence and scale call volume while having a hyper-local focus in an area with limited search volume. In addition, client had bias towards location-specific campaigns, which directed the initial strategy.

Initial Strategy:

Market 5 locations within one island of Hawaii. The client insisted on the Google Ads set up of:

- Distinct store location-specific campaigns per service (Tires, Auto Repair, and Brake Repair) with budget allocations per store and per service.
- Associated each store with its own phone number, promotions, geo-target area and its own landing page. This allowed location-specific promotions in core ad text, use of call extensions, and directly align budget allocations with the client's goals.

Initial Issues:

Even with this highly-segmented structure, the campaign ran into issues. One of which was that when users are shown a mainland area code in the call extensions they were much less likely to engage with the call extension.

The hope was that the hyper-relevancy of the ad text and landing pages would tap into as much volume as possible in the segmented geos, but found that the campaign was unable to fulfill even small budgets despite broad keywords and consistent optimization.

Under this structure it was clear that we would be unable to properly optimize or scale success.

Initial Results:

The results of the initial test revealed that we were missing out on available volume due to over-segmentation. The campaigns were unable to fulfill budget allocations per location, then eventually unable to fulfill them per service. Overall conversion volume during this time struggled and the overly-segmented account obscured the necessary insight for optimization.

New Approach:

The new solution within Google Ads was to combine all store locations into a single campaign per service (one Tires campaign, one Auto Repair, etc).

In order to serve the most relevant phone number to each user by geo, we elected to disable all call extensions, link each store's Google My Business (GMB) page with our Google Ads account, include Adtaxi's Google Ads tracking number on the GMB listing, and run location extensions in lieu of call extensions.

In order to serve location-specific promotions, we utilized the third headline and second description line to add extra qualifiers and used Sitelink Extensions linking to each location's coupon page. In order to prioritize or de-prioritize store locations based on the client's business goals, we labeled each zip or radial target within Google Ads Editor with its associated location name then set bid adjustments to align with those goals.

Revised Strategy Results:

The aggregated-location structure improved our ability to optimize, generated more quality leads, and paved a path to scale.

The aggregate structure also allowed us to detect data trends as keywords were not split per location. This helped us optimize and manage the account more quickly and efficiently. Therefore, we have been able to provide more insight to the client than ever before.

Most importantly, testing paid off. We went against popular beliefs and training and tested location extensions in lieu of call extensions. This was the crux of the benefit and yielded:

98%
Increase in new users

37%
Increase in Click-thru Rate

33%
Lower Cost-Per-Lead

94%
Increase in phone calls

56%
Increase in monthly revenue

Key Insights

The primary learning was in distinguishing which structure supported the greatest amount of success and scalability. While the location-specific set up may have worked well in a different area of the country or within a different industry, this Hawaiian city's auto service search volume couldn't support the level of segmentation initially tested.

Through testing and challenging conventional approaches, and in this case the client's beliefs, discovered that a single service-related campaign with several key workarounds in place was a more successful structure.